

Metrics Reference

A plain-language guide to every metric shown in the Stock Terminal, how it is calculated, how to read it, and — where one exists — a rough rule-of-thumb range.

Caveat that applies to everything below. "Good" and "bad" ranges are rules of thumb that vary enormously by **sector, business model, and stage of growth**. A software company and a bank are not comparable on most of these. Always judge a number against the company's own history and its direct peers, not an absolute threshold. All data comes from Yahoo Finance via `yfinance` and can be delayed, restated, or occasionally missing (shown as `N/A`).

1. Price & size

Metric	Meaning	How to read it
Price	Latest traded share price.	Quote only — meaningless for "cheap/expensive" without the valuation ratios below.
Market Cap	Share price × shares outstanding. The market's price tag on all equity.	Size bucket: mega >\$200B, large \$10–200B, mid \$2–10B, small \$300M–2B, micro <\$300M. Larger = generally more stable, slower growth.
Enterprise Value (EV)	Market cap + total debt – cash. What it would cost to buy the whole business, debt included.	Used in EV/EBITDA. Better than market cap for comparing companies with different debt loads.

2. Valuation ratios

How much you pay per unit of value. **Lower is usually cheaper**, but a low multiple can also signal a struggling business ("value trap"), and a high multiple can be justified by fast growth.

Metric	Formula	How to read it	Rough range
P/E (Trailing)	Price ÷ last-12-month EPS	Years of current earnings to "pay back" the price.	<15 cheap-ish, 15–25 average, >25 priced for growth. Negative if loss-making (shown N/A).
Forward P/E	Price ÷ estimated next-year EPS	Same idea, using analyst forecasts. Lower than trailing P/E implies expected earnings growth.	As above.
PEG	P/E ÷ expected earnings growth %	P/E adjusted for growth.	~1.0 is "fair for the growth"; <1 potentially undervalued; >2 expensive.
P/B (Price/Book)	Price ÷ book value per share	Price vs. net assets on the books.	<1 trades below book (cheap or troubled); 1–3 typical; high for asset-light firms.
P/S (Price/Sales)	Price ÷ revenue per share	Useful when earnings are negative.	<1 low, 1–3 moderate, >10 rich (common in high-growth tech).
P/C (Price/Cash)	Market cap ÷ total cash	How much cash backs the valuation.	Lower = more cash cushion.
P/FCF	Market cap ÷ free cash flow	Price vs. actual cash generated.	<15 attractive, 15–25 fair, >25 expensive. Negative FCF → N/A.
EV/EBITDA	Enterprise value ÷ EBITDA	Capital-structure-neutral valuation (ignores debt & tax differences).	<10 cheap, 10–15 average, >15 expensive (sector-dependent).
EPS	Net income ÷ shares outstanding (TTM)	Profit attributable to each share.	Higher and rising is better; compare growth, not the absolute level.

3. Profitability

How efficiently the company turns revenue and capital into profit. **Higher is better**, and consistency over time matters as much as the level.

Metric	Formula	How to read it	Rough range
Gross Margin %	$(\text{Revenue} - \text{COGS}) \div \text{revenue}$	Pricing power and production efficiency.	>40% strong, varies hugely (software 70%+, retail <30%).
Operating Margin %	$\text{Operating income} \div \text{revenue}$	Profit after running the business, before interest & tax.	>15% healthy; negative means core operations lose money.
EBITDA Margin %	$\text{EBITDA} \div \text{revenue}$	Operating profitability before non-cash (D&A) and financing items.	>20% generally strong; useful for capital-intensive firms.
Net Profit Margin %	$\text{Net income} \div \text{revenue}$	Bottom-line cents kept per sales dollar.	>10% solid, >20% excellent, negative = unprofitable.
ROE % (Return on Equity)	$\text{Net income} \div \text{shareholders' equity}$	Return generated on owners' capital.	>15% good. Caution: can be inflated by high debt or a small/negative equity base.
ROA % (Return on Assets)	$\text{Net income} \div \text{total assets}$	How well assets are used to make profit.	>5% decent; banks/utilities run lower, asset-light firms higher.
ROIC % (Return on Invested Capital)	$\text{After-tax operating profit} \div (\text{debt} + \text{equity})$	Return on all capital employed — the cleanest quality gauge.	Value is created only when ROIC > cost of capital (~8–10%) . >15% is excellent.
ROCE % (Return on Capital Employed)	$\text{EBIT} \div (\text{total assets} - \text{current liabilities})$	Pre-tax sibling of ROIC.	>15% strong; compare to ROIC and to peers.
Revenue/Share		Sales backing each share.	Rising over time is the signal to want.

Metric	Formula	How to read it	Rough range
	TTM revenue ÷ shares outstanding		

4. Financial health (balance sheet & liquidity)

Can the company pay its bills and survive a downturn?

Metric	Formula	How to read it	Rough range
Total Cash	Cash + short-term investments	Dry powder and safety buffer.	More is safer; compare to total debt.
Total Debt	Short- + long-term borrowings	Leverage load.	Judge against cash, equity, and EBITDA.
Total Equity	Assets – liabilities (book value)	Owners' stake / net worth.	Negative equity is a red flag (often from heavy buybacks or losses).
Debt/Equity	Total debt ÷ equity (as %)	Leverage relative to owners' capital.	<100% conservative, 100–200% moderate, >200% aggressive (except banks/utilities).
Current Ratio	Current assets ÷ current liabilities	Ability to cover bills due within a year.	>1 covers near-term obligations; 1.5–3 comfortable; <1 potential squeeze; very high may mean idle assets.
Quick Ratio	(Current assets – inventory) ÷ current liabilities	Stricter liquidity test (excludes inventory).	>1 strong; <1 relies on selling inventory to pay bills.
Free Cash Flow (FCF)	Operating cash flow – capital expenditure	Cash left for dividends, buybacks, and debt paydown.	Positive and growing is the goal; persistent negative FCF needs external funding.

5. Dividends

For income investors. Sustainability matters more than headline yield.

Metric	Formula	How to read it	Rough range
Dividend Rate / Estimate	Forward annual dividend per share	The current run-rate payout.	—
Dividend TTM	Dividends actually paid per share (trailing 12m)	What was really paid recently.	—
Dividend Yield %	Annual dividend ÷ price	Income return at today's price.	<2% low, 2–4% typical, 4–6% high, >7–8% often signals risk of a cut.
5Y Avg Yield %	Average yield over the last 5 years	Context for whether today's yield is unusually high/low.	Today's yield far above its 5Y average can flag a falling price or a stretched payout.
Payout Ratio %	Dividends ÷ earnings	Share of profit paid out.	<60% comfortable, 60–80% watch, >100% paying more than it earns (unsustainable unless temporary).
FCF Coverage	Free cash flow ÷ dividends paid	How many times cash flow covers the dividend.	≥1.2× safe, 0.8–1.2× tight, <0.8× under-covered.
Div Growth 3Y / 5Y %	Annualized dividend CAGR	Track record of raising the payout.	Steady positive growth is a sign of a healthy, confident payer.
Years ▲ Dividend	Consecutive completed years of rising dividends	Reliability streak.	10y+ = strong culture of returning cash; 25y+ = "dividend aristocrat" territory.
Ex-Dividend Date	Cutoff to own shares for the next dividend	Buy before this date to receive	—

Metric	Formula	How to read it	Rough range
		the upcoming dividend.	

6. Risk

Volatility, crowding, and distress signals.

Metric	Formula / source	How to read it	Ranges
Beta	Sensitivity of the stock vs. the market (S&P 500)	Volatility/ market-risk gauge.	$\beta = 1$ moves with the market; >1 amplified (1.5 $\approx$ 50% bigger swings); <1 more stable; <0 moves opposite the market.
Short Interest %	Shares sold short $\div$ public float	How much of the float is bet against.	$<5\%$ normal, 5–10% elevated, $>10\text{--}20\%$ heavily shorted (bearish sentiment and/or squeeze fuel).
Days to Cover	Short interest $\div$ average daily volume	Days of normal trading for shorts to buy back.	<1 easy to cover; $>5\text{--}7$ crowded short , higher squeeze potential.
Altman Z-Score	$1.2 \cdot WC/TA + 1.4 \cdot RE/TA + 3.3 \cdot EBIT/TA + 0.6 \cdot MktCap/TL + 1.0 \cdot Sales/TA$	Bankruptcy-risk gauge (higher = safer).	>2.99 "safe" zone, $1.81\text{--}2.99$ "grey" zone, <1.81 "distress" zone. Built for manufacturers — unreliable for banks/financials (shown N/A when inputs don't fit).
Piotroski F-Score	0–9 points across 9 fundamental tests (see below)	Overall fundamental strength.	7–9 strong, 4–6 middling, 0–3 weak. Needs a prior year of statements.

Piotroski F-Score — the 9 tests (1 point each): Profitability: (1) positive net income, (2) positive operating cash flow, (3) ROA improving year-over-year, (4) operating cash flow $>$ net income (earnings backed by cash). Leverage/liquidity: (5) lower long-term-debt ratio, (6) higher current ratio, (7) no new share issuance. Efficiency: (8) higher gross margin, (9) higher asset turnover.

7. Charts (deep-dive)

Revenue · Profit · Net Income · FCF (last 5 years)

Dollar bars per fiscal year: - **Revenue** — total sales. - **Gross Margin** (bar = gross profit \$) — hover shows the gross **margin %**. - **Operating Margin** (bar = operating income \$) — hover shows operating **margin %**. - **Net Income** (bar) — hover shows net **margin %**. - **FCF** — free cash flow.

Read it for: the trend (rising bars), and how much of each revenue dollar survives down to operating income, net income, and cash. Widening gaps between Revenue and the profit bars mean rising costs.

Growth · YoY % (last 5 years)

Year-over-year growth rate of **Revenue, EPS, and EBITDA**. Read it for: acceleration vs. deceleration and consistency. EPS growing faster than revenue usually means improving margins and/or buybacks. (Bars need a prior year, so the oldest statement year has no growth bar.)

Share Dilution (last 5 years)

Share counts as bars (left axis) with payout/yield as lines (right %-axis): - **Shares Outstanding** (bar) — total shares. **Falling = buybacks** (each remaining share owns more of the company); **rising = dilution** (your stake shrinks, often from stock-based compensation or equity raises). - **Float Shares** (bar) — shares freely tradable by the public. Only the latest year is available from the data source, so it appears on the most recent bar only. - **Treasury Shares** (bar) — repurchased shares held by the company (often ~0 for firms that retire bought-back shares). - **Dividend Yield %** (line) — historical yield (annual dividends ÷ year-end price). - **Payout Ratio %** (line) — dividends as a share of earnings, over time.

Read it for: whether management is returning capital (shrinking share count, steady/rising dividend) or diluting holders, and whether the payout ratio is creeping toward unsustainable levels.

8. Performance (price return)

Price-only returns over **YTD, 1Y, 3Y, 5Y, 10Y**. These **exclude dividends** (they are price appreciation only), so a high-yield stock's true total return is higher than shown here. Read it for: momentum and long-run track record — but past performance does not predict future returns.

How the deep-dive panels map to this doc

Panel in the app	Section here
Valuation	§1 Price & size, §2 Valuation ratios
Profitability	§3 Profitability
Financial Health	§4 Financial health
Dividend	§5 Dividends
Risk	§6 Risk
Revenue/Growth/Share-Dilution charts	§7 Charts
Performance columns	§8 Performance